

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

## This month in ALT:

The latest in movies, series, comics and even gadgets in dgt, plus the wacky world of fruit art, household items names after people, and interviews with industry bigwigs all await you this month...



## Mt Everest grows taller

Diplomats and scientists from both Nepal and China agreed on a new official height for Mt Everest which now stands at 8,848.86 meters or 29,032 feet. While the countries between which the mountain stands have not agreed on a height before, it has grown by about a metre.

<http://dgit.in/evrsttall>

## WHAT'S NEW

# Tracking plastic bottles in the Ganga

**R**esearchers wanted to investigate how rapidly and widely plastic waste can move in rivers, so they loaded 10 plastic bottles with electronics and released it into the Ganga. On board were SIM cards that periodically related location information back to the researchers. The researchers found that there was a lot of differences in what happened to the water bottles as they moved through the river, and eventually out at sea. One of the water bottles was captured by some unsuspecting person who extracted the electronics from the bottle and found a SIM card. This unidentified person then proceeded to insert the SIM card into a smartphone, and then logged into Facebook



and started using data. The researchers were stunned to see a usage of 300 MB on one of their SIM cards, when they had anticipated that there

wouldn't be more than 100 MB of data used per card over the duration of the experiment. Some of the bottles were damaged or lost their ability to transmit their data. Other bottles ended up getting caught in fishing nets, but the scientists were not disappointed by that as it gave a realistic picture of what happens to plastic waste.

<http://dgit.in/gngnaplstc>

## Ghosts of the South China Sea

**T**he South China Sea is the most important body of water in terms of the world economy, as one third of all global trade passes through these waters. However, it is also one of the most dangerous water bodies in the world, with the US and Chinese navies perpetually at a standoff, and on the brink of a confrontation. Who has control over the waters is a complicated matter that



goes back to people who lived centuries ago. Zheng He with his colossal armada established the trading routes for the Chinese. The Dutch lawyer Hugo Grotius called for free passage in the world's

waters, a passionate argument against Portuguese claims on the South China Sea. Then it was Theodore Roosevelt's almost maniacal quest for increasing the sea power of the US that has made its navy what it is today. The fourth ghost is Norman Angell, who won the Nobel Peace prize for arguing that war is never a good way to solve international disputes.

<http://dgit.in/scsghosts>



## Hacking penthouses

A young Hungarian art student in New York stunned by the sheer heights of the luxury apartments, pretended to be a billionaire buyer to get access to these exclusive apartments, from where she captured photos of the cityscape below, exhibited in an art project.

<http://dgit.in/hckapt>



## 27 year old baby born

A baby girl has been adopted from an embryo frozen in 1992, setting a new record for how long a human embryo has remained viable. The previous record was held by her elder sister (genetically related), who was born 24 years after the embryo was frozen.

<http://dgit.in/27yobaby>



## Dylan sells catalogue

Universal Music has signed a deal to purchase the entire songwriting catalogue of Bob Dylan, with more than 600 songs being part of the collection. The deal was made directly with the 79-year-old legend, for an undisclosed amount. It might be the biggest such acquisition ever.

<http://dgit.in/dylansell>